

Who can apply

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Eligibility requirements

You can come to Canada to study if you

- are enrolled at a [DLI](#)
- prove you have [enough money](#) to pay for
 - your tuition fees
 - living expenses for yourself **and** any family members who come with you to Canada and
 - return transportation for yourself **and** any family members who come with you to Canada
- obey the law, have no criminal record and get a [police certificate](#) (if required)
- are in good health and get a [medical exam](#) (if required) and
- prove to an officer that you will leave Canada when your study permit expires

Your responsibilities as a student

While studying in Canada you must

- make progress towards completing your program
- respect any conditions listed on your study permit
- stop studying if you no longer meet the requirements

Depending on your case, there may be conditions on your study permit such as

- if you're allowed to work in Canada
- the specific date you must leave Canada
- where you can study (a specific DLI listed on your permit)
 - You need to follow our instructions if you want to [change schools at the post-secondary level](#).
- whether you need an immigration medical examination

Who can study without a permit

Most [foreign nationals](#) need a study permit to study in Canada. The cases below are exceptions.

Short-term students

You don't need a study permit if you're coming to Canada for a program that lasts 6 months or less.

Family or staff of foreign representatives

You may not need a study permit if you're a family or staff member of a foreign representative to Canada that has been accredited by Global Affairs Canada (GAC). Your embassy can contact [GAC](#) to find out if you need one.

Members of the foreign armed forces of a country designated under the Visiting Forces Act (VFA)

You don't need a study permit if you're a member of a foreign armed force (as part of either the military or a designated civilian personnel) from a [country that is designated under the VFA](#) and you're on official duties in Canada.

You should be in possession of a letter of acceptance from Canada's Department of National Defence.

If your family members, including minor children, want to study in Canada, they may need a study permit.

Registered Indians in Canada

You don't need a study permit if you have [Registered Indian status](#) in Canada, even if you're a citizen of another country.

Minor children in Canada

Minor children don't need a study permit if

- they're refugees or refugee claimants
- their parents are refugees or refugee claimants
- their parents are Canadian citizens or permanent residents of Canada
- they're in Canada attending preschool, primary school or secondary school, and they are accompanied by a parent who is authorized to study or work in Canada
- they're in Canada unaccompanied, and they're attending preschool, primary school or secondary school

Why you may still want them to get a study permit

Having a valid study permit means the minor may be able to

- get a secondary school [co-op work permit](#)
- have [access to social services](#) in some provinces or territories
- [move between education levels](#) without needing to change or apply for a new permit
 - When minor children reach the age of majority (18 or 19 years old, depending on the [province or territory](#)), they must apply for a study permit if they want to keep studying.

Learn more about [minors studying in Canada](#).

Temporary residents and asylum seekers taking French language and culture courses

You don't need a study permit to take [French language and cultural integration courses](#) in Quebec (linked page is available in French only). To be eligible for the courses, you need to be a temporary resident or asylum seeker in Canada.

Temporary residents taking settlement and integration courses

If you're taking settlement and integration courses offered by a provincial or territorial government to help you settle into Canada, you don't need a study permit.

Construction apprentices in eligible trades

To be eligible to study without a study permit as a construction apprentice, you must meet all of the following criteria when you request your study permit exemption and once a decision has been made:

- You have a valid work permit.
- You have a job in an [eligible construction occupation\(opens in a new tab\)](#).
- You have an apprenticeship agreement registered with the relevant provincial or territorial apprenticeship and certification authority.

[Find out more about this temporary measure\(opens in a new tab\)](#).

Other types of workers who can study without a study permit

You may be eligible to study without a study permit if you are in either of the following situations:

1. You have a valid work permit that you applied for **on or before** June 7, 2023.
2. You have been issued a [letter authorizing you to work](#) while we process your work permit extension application that was submitted on or before June 7, 2023.

[Find out if you're eligible.](#)

Why you may still want to get a study permit

If you have a study permit and you're registered as a full-time student at a DLI, you may be able to work [on-campus](#) or [off-campus](#). If you are able to do so, your study permit will include a condition that says you're allowed to work while studying.

If you don't have a study permit, you can't work while you're studying in Canada. In this case, you need to [apply for a work permit](#).

Get the right documents

To apply for a study permit, there are some documents you need to include. In some cases, you may not need all of them. Make sure you know what applies to your situation.

1. Get your letter of acceptance Always required

Your school will give you a letter of acceptance. Upload this to your online application.

Post-secondary students

Your school will be asked to make sure your letter of acceptance (LOA) is valid.

If your school does not respond by the deadline, we'll return your application and refund your processing fee. Confirm with your school that they will validate your LOA before resubmitting your application.

Only attach your LOA in the LOA-specific space when uploading documents for your online application.

If you attach other documents in this space, you're giving your consent to disclose these additional documents to your school. All other required documents should be attached in the corresponding spaces in your online application.

Exceptions

If you're the family member of someone who has a study permit or work permit application that's been approved in writing before you come to Canada, you don't need a letter of acceptance.

2. Apply for a provincial or territorial attestation letter Needed in most cases

Get a [provincial or territorial attestation letter \(PAL/TAL\)](#) from your school. In most cases, you need to accept your offer and pay your tuition fees, either in part or in full, to get your PAL/TAL.

If you're [studying in Quebec](#), you need a Quebec Acceptance Certificate (Certificat d'acceptation du Québec [CAQ]).

3. Show proof of identity Always required

To show proof of identity, you (and each family member who comes with you) must have

- a copy of a [valid passport or travel document](#)
 - Upload a copy of the information page of your passport when you apply online.
 - **If you're approved**, you must send us your original passport.
- 2 recent passport size photos
 - The name and date of birth of the person must be written on the back of each photo.

For citizens or lawful permanent residents of the United States (U.S.)

If you're a citizen of the U.S., you have [options for what you can show as proof of identity](#).

If you're a lawful permanent resident of the U.S., you must travel with a valid green card ([or equivalent official proof of status in the U.S.](#)) and a valid passport from their country of nationality (or an equivalent document).

4. Show proof of funds Always required

To support yourself and any family members coming with you, you must show [proof of funds](#).

5. Write a letter of explanation Recommended

You must explain why you want to study in Canada, and that you understand your responsibilities as an international student in Canada.

6. Get a medical exam Check if needed

You may need a medical exam if **any** of these situations apply to you:

- You plan to stay in Canada for more than 6 months.
- You recently spent time in certain countries.
- You plan to work in certain jobs where public health must be protected.

[Check if you need a medical exam](#).

7. Get a police certificate Check if needed

In some cases, we may ask you for a [police certificate](#). If you think you might need one, [you should apply for one as early as possible](#).

8. Proof of care (for minor children in Canada) Check if needed

Children under the age of 17 who are not coming to Canada with a parent or legal guardian must have an appointed custodian.

[Find out what you need to submit for children under the age of 17](#).

9. Check for other documents you might need based on what country you're applying from Check if needed

There may be other documents to submit that are specific to your local visa office. To get your local visa office instructions:

- Go to the [How to apply](#) page
- Select "Outside Canada"
- Select "Apply online"
- Select your country or territory from the list.

If you aren't currently in your home country, you may have to prove your immigration status in the country you apply from.

If the government that issued your passport or travel document needs you to have a re-entry permit, you must get one before you apply for a Canadian visa. You may also need other documents.

Extra documents are needed for Venezuelan passport holders

If the printed expiry date has passed and you're applying for a visitor visa, study permit, work permit or to extend your stay as a temporary resident in Canada, follow these steps:

5. Add 5 years to the printed expiry date shown on your passport, and enter it in the "Expiry date" field of the application form.
6. Include a letter of explanation with your application stating: "I am a Venezuelan national with a Venezuelan passport which has been extended for 5 years."

Warning: If your passport is still expired after adding 5 years to the printed expiry date, your passport is considered expired. You're not eligible to submit an application with that passport.

Provincial attestation letter or territorial attestation letter

A provincial attestation letter (PAL) or a territorial attestation letter (TAL) is a letter provided by the province or territory where you plan to study. It confirms that you've been assigned one of the available spaces to study in that province or territory. Most study permit applicants need to provide a PAL or TAL when they apply, unless they meet one of the exceptions.

On this page

- [Who needs a PAL/TAL](#)
 - [Getting your PAL/TAL](#)
 - [How long a PAL or TAL is valid](#)
 - [When to get a new PAL/TAL](#)
- [Studying in Quebec](#)
- [Who doesn't need a PAL or TAL](#)

Who needs a PAL/TAL

Unless you meet one of the [exceptions](#), you must submit a PAL/TAL

- **with** your application, not after
- when you apply for a prerequisite course or program
 - This includes language courses or programs.
- for each study permit applicant, even if you're applying as a family and submitting your applications together

Getting your PAL/TAL

Contact your school to find out how to apply for a PAL/TAL. Once you have one, you can apply for a study permit.

If you're applying to a school in Quebec, [follow the instructions below](#).

How long a PAL or TAL is valid

Unless it has an expiry date on it, it's valid

- **until December 31, 2025**, for the **2025** study permit cap year
 - This means that your PAL or TAL was issued between January 22, 2025, and December 31, 2025.
- **until December 31, 2026**, for the **2026** study permit cap year
 - This means that your PAL or TAL was issued between January 1, 2026, and December 31, 2026.

Your PAL or TAL needs to be valid when you apply. You can't use a PAL or TAL that was issued during a previous study permit cap year.

When to get a new PAL/TAL

You can reapply with the same PAL/TAL if

- your PAL/TAL is still valid, **and**
- your study permit application was accepted for processing and you voluntarily withdrew your application before a final decision was made, **or**
- your study permit application was not accepted for processing
 - This means that your fee was refunded and you were told that your application was not processed.

You must get a **new** PAL/TAL before you reapply if

- your PAL/TAL has expired or is no longer valid, **or**
- your previous study permit application was approved or refused, **or**
- you're [changing schools](#), **or**
- you're changing your level of study
 - This means you're moving from
 - the secondary level to the post-secondary level, **or**
 - the graduate level to the post-secondary level
 - You don't need a **new** PAL/TAL when moving from the post-secondary level to a degree-granting graduate program at a public designated learning institution (DLI).

If you're reapplying to study in Quebec, find out if you need to [renew your authorizations](#).

Studying in Quebec

Quebec Acceptance Certificate

If you want to study in Quebec, you need an attestation of issuance of your **Quebec Acceptance Certificate (Certificat d'acceptation du Québec [CAQ])**, which is issued by the Government of Quebec. Contact your school to find out how to apply for the CAQ.

Who needs a CAQ

Most students who don't need a PAL or TAL and want to study in Quebec **must** still get a CAQ. There are very few [exceptions](#).

Make sure your CAQ is valid when you apply

A CAQ received before January 22, 2025, will be accepted for the 2025 study permit cap year if it is valid when you apply.

Your CAQ needs to include the following line :

"This attestation letter confirms that the applicant has a place in Quebec's share of the distribution of study permit applications or is exempt from it."

CAQs for applications received **before 8:30 a.m. ET on January 22, 2024**, did **not** require the above line.

Re-using a CAQ

You can apply for a study permit again with the same valid CAQ, no matter what the decision was on your last application, unless you're changing your level of study.

When **changing schools**, you **can only** apply for a study permit again with the same valid CAQ if

- your CAQ was issued before December 6, 2024, and you're changing schools **at the same level of study**
- you're a minor child at the primary or secondary level and your CAQ is **not** linked to a specific school

[Find out which documents you need to study in Quebec.](#)

Who doesn't need a PAL or TAL

You **don't** need a PAL or TAL when applying for a study permit if any of the following applies to you.

- You're applying to study at a
 - preschool
 - primary school (including kindergarten)

- secondary school (up to grade 12)
- **degree-granting** graduate program at the [master's or doctoral level](#) at a **public DLI** **Starting January 1, 2026**
- school participating in the [Francophone Minority Communities Student Pilot \(FMCSF\)](#) **and** you have a letter of acceptance from this school identifying you as an applicant under the FMCSF
- federally designated military college **or**
- school in Quebec in a vocational training program that leads to one of the following:
 - a diploma of vocational studies (DVS)
 - an attestation of vocational specialization (AVS)
 - a skills training certificate (STC)
- You're an exchange student studying under an exchange arrangement between your home institution and a DLI in Canada, and you don't pay tuition fees to the DLI.
- You've received a scholarship from Global Affairs Canada.
- You're in Canada or entering Canada at a port of entry and are eligible for an exemption from certain study permit requirements based on a public policy as part of a migration response to a crisis or other pressure.
- You're exempt from certain study permit requirements under the [temporary measures to reunite families of Indigenous people separated by Canada's border](#).
- You've entered Canada **and** one of the following situations applies to you:
 - You're applying for a study permit extension at the same DLI **and** level of study as your current study permit.
 - You're under a removal order, but can't be removed from Canada at this time.
 - You have a [temporary resident permit](#) valid for at least 6 months.
 - You're a [protected person](#).
 - You're eligible for permanent residence
 - based on [humanitarian and compassionate grounds](#), **or**
 - based on a current [public policy](#), **or**
 - as a spouse or common-law partner (through the spouse or common-law partner in Canada class)

You need to [provide proof](#) that you meet one of the above exceptions if you don't provide a PAL/TAL with your study permit application.

Proof of financial support

You must prove that you have enough money, **without** working in Canada, to pay for all the following:

- tuition fees for the course or program of studies
- living expenses for yourself and the family members who come with you while you're in Canada
- transportation to and from Canada for yourself and your accompanying family members

How to show you meet the financial support requirements

You must provide us with documents that prove you have the **required funds available** for all the costs listed above. This means that

1. you must **show** you have enough financial resources for the **first year** of your studies
2. for programs more than a year long, you must also **tell us how you plan to pay** for the full duration of your studies
 - For example: You can show proof that your scholarship is more than a year long, proof that your parents are employed, etc.

The documents below are **examples** of common proofs of funds you can use.

- It's not a complete list. There may be other types of documents you can provide as proof instead.
- You don't need to provide all of these documents to show you meet the financial support requirements.

Common documents that can be used to show proof of funds:

- proof you paid for the first year of your tuition and housing fees
 - This must be accompanied by other documents proving you have [sufficient funds to cover living expenses](#) and transportation costs.
- proof of a Canadian bank account in your name, if you've transferred money to Canada
- a [guaranteed investment certificate](#) from a participating Canadian financial institution
- proof of a student or education loan from a bank
- your bank statements (for your Canadian or foreign bank account) for the past 4 months
- a bank draft that can be converted to Canadian dollars
- a letter from the person or institution giving you money
 - This must be accompanied by other documents showing proof of funds.
- proof of financial support within Canada, if you have a scholarship or are in a Canadian-funded educational program

[Other documents](#) may also be required. Check the visa office instructions for your country or region for local requirements.

If your country uses foreign exchange controls, you must prove that you'll be allowed to export funds for all of your expenses.

How much money you need for living expenses

This chart tells you how much money you will need to support yourself and your family members in Canada for the first year of your program of studies. These amounts are updated each year.

These amounts **do not** include tuition and transportation costs.

If you apply **on or after September 1, 2025**

All provinces and territories except Quebec

Number of family members (including the applicant)	Amount required per year (excluding tuition and transportation costs) (in CAN\$)
1	\$22,895
2	\$28,502

Number of family members (including the applicant)	Amount required per year (excluding tuition and transportation costs) (in CAN\$)
3	\$35,040
4	\$42,543
5	\$48,252
6	\$54,420
7	\$60,589
If more than 7 people, each additional family member	\$6,170

Example: If you and 2 family members want to come to a province or territory (other than Quebec) for a year, you'll need \$35,040 for living expenses.

If you apply between January 1, 2024, and August 31, 2025 (inclusively)

All provinces and territories except Quebec

Number of family members (including the applicant)	Amount required per year (excluding tuition and transportation costs) (in CAN\$)
1	\$20,635
2	\$25,690
3	\$31,583
4	\$38,346
5	\$43,492
6	\$49,051
7	\$54,611
If more than 7 people, each additional family member	\$5,559

Example: If you and 2 family members want to come to a province or territory (other than Quebec) for a year, you'll need \$31,583 for living expenses.

Quebec

To obtain a Quebec Acceptance Certificate (Certificat d'acceptation du Québec [CAQ]) and study in Quebec, applicants must show they can financially cover the costs outlined by the [Ministère de l'Immigration, de la Francisation et de l'Intégration](#).

How to apply

Generally, you must apply for a study permit **before you come to Canada**. Some people can apply for a study permit from within Canada. In some cases, you can apply when you arrive in Canada at the port of entry. Make sure you understand which option is available to you.

Get your documents ready

When you apply, you should submit

- the **letter of acceptance** from the [designated learning institution \(DLI\)](#) you'll be attending
- a [provincial attestation letter \(PAL\) or territorial attestation letter \(TAL\)](#)
 - You can upload your PAL/TAL into the **Provincial attestation letter (required)** field in your application. If this option is missing, you must upload your PAL/TAL to the **Client information** field. If you meet an exception, you must provide any evidence in the **Client information** field.
- as many of the [documents needed for a complete application](#) as possible
 - We won't be able to finalize your study permit until you've submitted a complete application.
 - Waiting to submit documents will cause delays in processing.

Apply online

If you're applying for a study permit, you **must apply online**, whether you're outside of Canada or already in Canada.

You're only eligible to apply on paper if you

- have a disability that prevents you from applying online
- hold an identity or travel document for non-national residents, refugees or stateless persons

Get faster processing as a doctoral student New

If you're a doctoral (PhD) student, you and your accompanying family members may be able to get faster processing on your applications.

[Check if you're eligible and learn how to get your applications processed faster.](#)

Get specific instructions on how to apply

In Canada study permit applicants: New rules about applying at a port of entry

Most foreign nationals **already in Canada** can [no longer apply for a study permit at a port of entry](#). You must apply online for

- your [initial study permit](#)
- your [study permit extension](#)

If you're outside of Canada, you [may still be eligible to apply for a study permit](#) when you arrive at a port of entry.

If you're in Canada and leave as a student on [maintained status](#), you'll lose your ability to study when you return. This means you can't study until your application is approved.

Venezuelan passport holders

You may need to [complete extra steps when you fill out your application](#).

Answer a few questions to get the next steps for your situation.

Where are you applying from? **(required)**

- Outside Canada
- Within Canada
- At a port of entry

After you apply

- **1. Your fingerprints and photo (biometrics)**
- Book your biometrics collection appointment as soon as you can to avoid processing delays. [Find out how to give biometrics.](#)
- **2. We process your study permit application**
- We'll check your application to make sure you have all the necessary documents. If it's incomplete, we may return your application without processing it or request the missing documents.
- We may also ask you to
- go to an interview with our officials **in your country** or
- send us more information
- You may also need to get a
- [medical exam](#) (if required) or
- [police certificate](#) (if required)
- If you want to defer your enrolment while we process your application
- If you want to defer your enrolment (which means you want to start studying later than planned) at the designated learning institution (DLI) that has already issued your letter of acceptance (LOA), you need to
- get your deferral **approved** by the DLI
- get an **updated** [LOA](#)
- You must then submit your updated LOA to us through your [online account](#) or our [web form](#).
- **Missing documents**
- If you weren't able to submit all the required documents with your application, you can submit the missing documents through your [online account](#) or [our web form](#).
- We won't process your study permit until you've submitted a complete application. Waiting to submit documents will cause delays in processing.
- **Updating your application**
- If you move or change your address, telephone number or any other contact information after you apply, you must [update your application](#).
- **There's a new way to check your application status**
- Use the [application status tracker](#)(opens in a new tab) to get updates about your application. To create an account you need your
- [unique client identifier](#) (UCI)
- [application number](#)

- **3. If we approve your application**
- You'll get your study permit
- at the port of entry when you arrive in Canada or
- mailed to you, if you're already in Canada
- **If you applied for your study permit from outside Canada**
- We'll send you a port of entry [letter of introduction](#) that says you're allowed to study in Canada. This letter is **not** your study permit.
- You need to bring this letter with you and show it to a border services officer when you arrive in Canada. We'll also send you an [electronic travel authorization \(eTA\)](#) or a visitor visa ([temporary resident visa](#)) to enter Canada, if you need one.
- If you're from a country where you need an **eTA**, the letter of introduction will include information about your eTA. Your eTA will be linked to your passport and is valid for 5 years or until your passport expires, whichever comes first. It's important that you travel with **the passport you used when you applied** for your study permit.
- If you're from a country where you need a **visitor visa**, the visa will be in your passport. It'll show if you can enter Canada once or multiple times. You must enter Canada before your visa expires.
- If you're a lawful permanent resident of the United States, travel with a valid green card (or [equivalent official proof of status in the US](#)) and a valid passport from your country of nationality (or an equivalent document).
- **If you applied for your study permit from within Canada**
- If you were eligible to apply from within Canada, you filled out a form called "Application to change conditions, extend my stay or remain in Canada as a student" (IMM 5709).
- In this case, we'll mail the study permit to the Canadian address you gave us.
- If your mailing address changes before we send you our decision, you must [give us your new address](#).
- **Studying while you wait for your study permit to arrive**
- We'll send you a letter of approval in your online account to let you know your study permit has been approved. You can start studying as soon as you get this letter. You don't have to wait until you get your study permit in the mail to start studying.
- **If we refuse your application**
- We'll send you a letter explaining why.
- We may refuse your application if you don't
- have a [valid letter of acceptance](#)
- show proof that you have enough money to support yourself while studying in Canada
- pass your medical exam, if you needed to get one
- convince the visa officer that your main purpose in Canada is to study or
- convince the visa officer that you'll leave Canada at the end of your study period
- If you have questions about why you were refused, contact the visa office that sent you the refusal letter.

Prepare for your arrival

Before you come to Canada

- Before you arrive, read the [pre-departure guide](#) for tips and information about student life in Canada.
- To help ensure a smooth arrival in Canada, please check the Canadian Border Service Agency's [information for international students](#), and download their [PDF pamphlet \(PDF, 592 KB\)](#).

How early can you arrive in Canada before you start studying

- There is no set time frame for you to arrive in Canada before you begin your studies. You should just give yourself a reasonable amount of time to prepare before you start studying.
- You are **not allowed** to work on or off campus until you begin your studies in Canada.
- **Changing your designated learning institution if you're outside Canada**
- If your application for a study permit has been approved and you change your designated learning institution (DLI), you must submit a new study permit application with a new letter of acceptance. You must also [pay all the fees](#) for the new application.
- If you want to defer your enrolment before arriving in Canada
- If your application has been approved and you want to defer your enrolment (which means you want to start studying later than planned) at the DLI that has already issued your letter of acceptance (LOA), you need to
 - get your deferral **approved** by the DLI
 - get an **updated** [LOA](#)
 - have a **valid** [letter of introduction](#)
- You need to show these documents at the port of entry when you arrive in Canada.

When you arrive in Canada

- When you arrive in Canada, you'll meet a [border services officer](#) who will make sure you meet some basic requirements. To enter Canada, you must
 - have a valid travel document, such as a passport
 - have the port of entry [letter of introduction](#) the visa office sent you when they approved your study permit
 - This letter has your permit reference number, which we use to issue your study permit.
 - have a copy of a valid letter of acceptance from your school
 - have letters of reference or any other documents the visa office told you to bring
 - have a valid [electronic travel authorization](#) (eTA), a valid visitor visa (temporary resident visa), a valid green card (or [equivalent official proof of U.S. status](#)) or another valid travel document
 - If you have a valid eTA, it'll be linked to the passport you used to apply for your study permit.
 - have enough money for your stay (the amount you will need can vary—it depends on things such as how long you will stay, and whether you will stay in a hotel, or with friends or relatives)
 - be in good health
 - have no criminal or immigration-related convictions
 - convince an immigration officer that
 - you have ties—such as a job, home, financial assets or family—that will take you back to your home country
 - you will leave Canada at the end of your visit

have valid immigration medical exam results ([if you needed one](#))

- Your exam is valid for 12 months from the day you get it.
- It must be valid the day you enter Canada.
- If your exam will expire before you enter Canada, you need to [get another medical exam](#).
- This applies even if your letter of introduction is still valid.
- prove that you'll leave Canada at the end of your stay

If you need proof you entered Canada

- Your school or training facility may need you to prove you entered Canada. If you need proof of entry, make sure a border services officer stamps your passport before you leave Canadian customs. You may also be able to use a [Primary Inspection Kiosk](#) to stamp your passport.

Inadmissibility

- Some people are inadmissible—they're not allowed to come to Canada. Several things can make you inadmissible, including involvement in criminal activity, in human rights violations or in organized crime.
- You can also be inadmissible for security, health or financial reasons. [Find out more about inadmissibility](#).

While you study

- While you're studying in Canada as an international student, you must meet the conditions of your study permit and keep your profile information updated in your online account. If your study program is ending soon, you also need to know how long you can stay in Canada and what to do if you plan to stay longer.

On this page

- [Updating your profile information](#)
- [Changing the conditions of your study permit](#)
- [How long your study permit is valid](#)
- [Staying in Canada after you graduate](#)

Updating your profile information

- If information in your profile changes, **you must** update it in your online account.
- You may need to update your profile if you
- need to update documents or your contact information

Changing schools

- Before you change your school, you must meet all the conditions of your study permit. This means you must be
- enrolled at a [designated learning institution \(DLI\)](#) and
- actively studying at that DLI
- You need to follow our instructions if you are changing schools at the post-secondary level.
- In addition, if you are in a co-op program and are changing to a co-op program at a different school, you must apply for a new co-op work permit.

If your DLI loses its designated status

- If the DLI you're studying at loses its [designated status](#)

- you can keep studying until your current study permit expires
- you won't be able to extend your permit unless the institution has been re-designated by its province or territory
- you will not be able to apply for a study permit extension to begin a new program at a de-designated institution
- you can apply for a study permit extension to change DLIs
- As long as you are in one of the [eligible](#) situations, you are allowed to begin studying at your new DLI right after you apply, rather than wait for your study permit extension to be approved.

If your DLI is placed on the suspension list

- If the DLI you're studying at is **placed on the suspension list**
- you can keep studying until your current study permit expires
- you will be able to extend your study permit to complete your current program, if necessary
- you will not be able to apply for a study permit extension to begin a new program at a suspended DLI
- you can apply for a study permit extension to change DLIs
- As long as you are in one of the [eligible](#) situations, you are allowed to begin studying at your new DLI right after you apply, rather than wait for your study permit extension to be approved.
- [Learn more about changing schools.](#)

Updating your contact information or documents

Contact information

- You must keep the contact information on your study permit up to date. If your contact information changes, [use our web form](#) to update it.

Medical exams

- If you plan to leave Canada while you're studying, you'll need a new immigration medical exam (IME) to return if
- you're from a country that requires a valid IME to enter Canada **and**
- your IME has expired or will expire while you're outside of Canada
- [Find out if you need an IME to return to Canada as an international student.](#)

Changing the conditions of your study permit

- If you want to change a condition on your study permit, you must apply.
- [Find more information about your study permit conditions.](#)

How long your study permit is valid

- A study permit is usually valid for the length of your study program, plus an extra 90 days. The 90 days let you either
- prepare to leave Canada or
- [apply to extend your stay](#)
- The amount of time you can stay in Canada after you've completed your studies depends on whether
- [you're taking prerequisite courses](#)
- [your study permit will expire before you finish your studies](#)

- [you'll finish your studies before your study permit expires](#)

If your study permit will expire before you finish your studies

- If your study permit will expire **before** you finish your courses, you must [apply to extend your stay as a student](#).
- If you don't, you'll need to stop studying and leave Canada.

If you'll finish your studies before your study permit expires

- If you finish your studies early, your study permit will stop being valid **90 days after you complete your studies**, no matter what day is printed on the study permit.
- Your studies are officially completed on the date your school first notifies you by any of the following:
 - completion letter
 - transcript
 - degree or diploma
- You must provide proof of the date your school notifies you **or** the date you get your degree, diploma or certificate. If you don't have proof, we'll use the earliest issue date on the document. We may confirm this date with your school.

Staying in Canada after you graduate

- You may be able to [work temporarily or live permanently in Canada after you graduate](#).

Study permit conditions

On this page

- [Your study permit conditions](#)
- [How to prove that you meet your conditions](#)
- [People who are exempt from study permit conditions](#)

Your study permit conditions

- As a study permit holder, you need to meet a number of conditions. If you don't meet these conditions, you may lose your student status and study permit. You may also have to leave Canada.
- As a study permit holder, you must
 - be enrolled at a [designated learning institution \(DLI\)](#), unless you're exempt
 - show you're actively pursuing your studies, unless you're exempt, by
 - being enrolled full-time or part-time during each academic semester (excluding regularly scheduled breaks)
 - If you're studying in **Quebec**, make sure to [check the province's specific requirements](#).
 - making progress towards completing your program's courses **and**
 - not taking [authorized leaves longer than 150 days](#) from your study program
 - apply to extend your study permit to change post-secondary schools
 - end your studies if you no longer meet the requirements of being a student **and**
 - leave Canada when your permit expires

Other study permit conditions you may need to follow

- You may have other conditions listed on your study permit. You must follow these conditions, which could include
- the level of studies
- if you're allowed to [work on or off campus as a student](#) in Canada
- if you need to report for medical procedures
- if you're allowed to travel within Canada, and
- the date you must stop studying.

If you've deferred your enrolment

- If you've deferred your enrolment and the DLI that issued your letter of acceptance is de-designated before you start studying, you cannot start studying at that school.
- If you're in Canada with a valid study permit, you'll need to
- apply to and be accepted at a new DLI
- apply to extend your study permit
- If your study permit has been approved but not issued yet
- we'll send you a request to provide a new letter of acceptance from a new DLI

What counts as an authorized leave from your studies?

- There are a few cases where you may be able to take a leave of up to a **maximum of 150 days** from your program of studies and still be considered to be actively pursuing your studies.
- You don't need to tell us if you're taking an authorized leave. However, if we ask for it, you must provide proof that your leave is
- **authorized** by your DLI and
- no longer than 150 days
- It counts as authorized leave if
- your school has authorized a leave from your study program for
- medical reasons or pregnancy
- family emergency
- death or serious illness of a family member
- any other type of leave your school authorizes
- your school has closed permanently or because of a strike
- you've changed schools
- you or your school deferred your program start date
- In this case, you must start your studies the next semester, even if it starts sooner than 150 days, and get an updated letter of acceptance.

You can't work on or off campus during an authorized leave from your study program, even if your study permit says you're allowed to work in Canada.

- If your school is temporarily closed because of a strike, and you're authorized to work on or off campus, you remain authorized to work up to a maximum of 150 days.

How to prove that you meet your conditions

- We might ask you to prove you're meeting your conditions:
 - as part of a random check
 - if we have reason to believe you're not meeting them
- We might ask you for:
 - official documents from your school confirming:
 - your enrolment status
 - the reason for and start date of any leave you've taken
 - the date you withdrew from a school or study program
 - the date you were suspended or dismissed from a school or study program
 - the date you stopped studying at the school
 - official transcripts
 - references from people who know you
 - proof from a medical professional confirming the medical need for a leave from your study program
 - document confirming your school has closed and no longer offers your study program
 - any other document an officer finds relevant

What happens if you don't meet your study permit conditions

- If we find you haven't met your study permit conditions, we may ask you to leave Canada. You might also have to wait 6 months before you can apply for a new study permit (or for a visitor visa or work permit in Canada).
- The outcome of any future applications you submit could be impacted if you do either of the following:
 - you don't follow your study permit conditions
 - you work or study in a way we haven't authorized

People who are exempt from study permit conditions

- If you meet all of your [study permit conditions](#), you get to keep your study permit and status as a student. However, some study permit holders are exempt from certain conditions.
- You **don't need to prove that you're enrolled at a DLI or that you're actively pursuing your studies** if:
 - you or a family member (spouse or dependent child) has made a refugee claim in Canada that hasn't yet been decided on
 - you have refugee status in Canada
 - you or a family member (spouse or dependent child) are a Convention refugee or a humanitarian-protected person
 - you're an accredited representative of another country, the United Nations, or any international organization of which Canada is a member, or you're the staff or family member (spouse or dependent child) of this person

- you or your family member (spouse or dependent child) is a member of a foreign armed force in Canada on official duties
- you already have a study permit and have suddenly become impoverished for reasons beyond your control and temporarily can't continue your studies
- you're studying in Canada under a student exchange agreement between Canada and another country
- you or your family member (spouse or dependent child) works in Canada:
 - for the United States Immigration and Naturalization Service
 - for United States Customs
 - as an American member of the International Joint Commission
 - as a grain inspector for the United States
- you or your family member (spouse or dependent child) have a passport from the United States and are working temporarily in Canada on behalf of the United States government
- you're the family member (spouse or dependent child) of someone who lives in Canada and who:
 - holds a Canadian study or work permit
 - has a Canadian temporary resident permit valid for at least 6 months
 - has a removal order against them, but who can't be removed from Canada
 - is part of a foreign armed forces and is in Canada on official duties
 - is a representative from a foreign government sent to work with a federal or provincial agency in Canada
 - is participating in sport activities or events in Canada
 - works for a foreign news company and is in Canada to report on events
 - works in Canada as a member of the clergy
- Even if you're exempt from proving that you're enrolled at a DLI or that you're actively pursuing your studies, you **still** need to meet all the other [conditions listed on your study permit](#). Make sure you know what these conditions are.